



Michigan Tech

Shane Mueller <shanem@mtu.edu>

Re: GSE in openscales repository

1 message

Schwarzer, Ralf <ralf.schwarzer@fu-berlin.de>
To: Shane Mueller <shanem@mtu.edu>
Cc: "Schwarzer, Ralf" <ralf.schwarzer@fu-berlin.de>

Wed, Jun 17, 2026 at 3:52 AM

Dear Prof. Mueller,

thank you for your valuable initiative. This sounds like an excellent project.

Certainly, you can include the GSE scale as well as all other of my scales in your OpenScale system under the creative-commons license.

I wish you much success with your project.

Regards

Prof. Dr. Ralf Schwarzer
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14195 Berlin, Germany
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Google Scholar | <https://scholar.google.de/citations?user=w2M4elUAAAAJ&hl=en>

From: Shane Mueller <shanem@mtu.edu>
Sent: Wednesday, June 17, 2026 07:14
To: Schwarzer, Ralf
Subject: GSE in openscales repository

Prof Schwarzer,

I've read your documentation on GSE and how you cannot respond to requests about it, but I hope you will make an exception, as it may help users access the GSE without needing to make permission requests.

I've recently launched the openscales project (<http://openscales.net>), which is an effort to create an interchange file format for psychological scales, and a repository for open-licensed scales that is approaching 1000 free scales. I'm wondering if you'd be willing to contribute GSE under a creative-commons license (see <https://creativecommons.org/cc-licenses/>; the most common is CC_BY 4.0) so that I can re-publish and re-distribute it as part of the repository. From my interpretation of your FAQ document, this is not something you allow, but doing so would permit users to continue to use the GSE without requiring your direct permission, and it will be maintained on github and likely other archives for future generations to use. You already distribute the scale free to use, and this would codify the ability to reuse, as well as re-distribute and republish with attribution (e.g., including in

method or results sections of papers), which improves transparency and interpretability of research.

I have implemented the GSE and the 31 translations you have on your website, and have generated an openscales file and page that is currently private (you need the url to get to it so people cannot just stumble on it):

<https://openscales.net/scale.php?code=GSE&repo=private>

This page allows you to select a language, test it via a web-based survey runner that generates local data files, convert it to a format that can be imported into some common survey tools, get a printable/editable copy, and it provides instructions to self-host a study.

I'd prefer contributions to be CC_BY which requires attribution to reuse, but if you have terms under which you would permit us to host the scale, or prefer another CC license version, I could host this under a 'restricted' repository. If you are not interested, I understand and hope you will be able to use the attached .osd and .csv files containing the scale items, logic, and translations. Feel free to distribute this on your website or however you want--it will give users an easy way of importing the correct text into several different survey platforms via the openscales tools. Also, the csv spreadsheet I attached aligns all of the translation items--I used this to build the OSD file and you or your users may find it handy to access all of the translations in one file. If you want to self-host this via your own website or public archive like OSF, I have plans for a registry of external OSD files so users of the openscales project could still find and use it.

Please let me know if you are willing to contribute the GSE to the repository, and whether one of the CC licenses would be acceptable. Of course, I'm also interested in including any of the other scales you have developed over the years, so I'd be interested in discussing those as well.

Best wishes,
Shane Mueller

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